MANATOBI / ORIGINAL PRACTICE

英検2級
リーディングトレーニング

第4回 問題冊子

リスニング・英作文を含まない部分練習 ／ 全31問

大問	問題番号	内容
1	1〜17	短文の語句空所補充
2	18〜23	長文の語句空所補充
3	24〜31	読解

使い方

・解答用紙に答えを記入してください。問題冊子には正答を載せていません。
・問題・解説はA4縦、解答用紙はA4横。白黒・片面・実際のサイズ（100%）で印刷します。
・解き終わるまでは、別冊の解答・解説を開かないでください。
・同じ問題をアプリの分野別練習でも解けます。

独自作成した英検2級形式のリーディング第4回です。リスニング・英作文・面接は含みません。公式教材ではなく、CSE・合否換算はしません。筆記全体の公式時間をリーディングだけの時間に流用しません。外部難度校正は未実施です。

氏名：＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿

1

短文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

(1) The harbor authority decided to ( ) the old stone pier so larger passenger ferries could dock safely.

1 lighten **2** lessen **3** loosen **4** lengthen

(2) Because the two printers share a single cable, only one user can send a document at any ( ) moment.

1 gifted **2** given **3** guided **4** gathered

(3) Although the herbal ointment has an unpleasant smell, it is remarkably effective at ( ) insect bites.

1 summoning **2** scattering **3** soothing **4** straining

(4) All summer outdoor workshops were moved indoors ( ) the municipal heat-stroke alert issued at noon.

1 in accordance with **2** on behalf of **3** by means of **4** in contrast to

(5) Before exporting wooden toys to Europe, the workshop had every paint sample ( ) for chemical safety.

1 complicated **2** circulated **3** cultivated **4** certified

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(6) Even seasoned mountain guides are (　　) to cross that narrow ridge when visibility drops below fifty meters.

1 reluctant　**2** redundant　**3** radiant　**4** relevant

(7) The mayor's proposal met with stiff (　　) from shopkeepers worried about losing curbside loading spaces.

1 obligation　**2** opposition　**3** observation　**4** occupation

(8) Were the city library to open an hour earlier on weekdays, commuters (　　) return books before boarding the train.

1 will　**2** can　**3** could　**4** have

(9) Small island clinics keep solar-powered refrigerators so vaccine supplies remain (　　) even if the main grid fails.

1 idle　**2** intact　**3** immense　**4** indirect

(10) Once the rain subsided, stadium staff worked swiftly to (　　) puddles from the running track before the relay.

1 droop　**2** drown　**3** drift　**4** drain

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(11) The two pottery towns developed remarkably similar glazes, quite (　　) of any trade contact between them.

1 independently　**2** indefinitely　**3** indifferently　**4** insufficiently

(12) Inspectors warned that neglecting minor roof leaks could lead to (　　) rot in the temple's cedar pillars.

1 irregular　**2** irrelevant　**3** irreversible　**4** irresponsible

(13) To prevent confusion at the crossroads, the hiking club asked volunteers to (　　) faded wooden trail signs.

1 repay　**2** repel　**3** repeal　**4** repaint

(14) Although the pocket translator handles tourist phrases well, its accuracy has clear (　　) in legal discussions.

1 obligations　**2** foundations　**3** limitations　**4** proportions

(15) Farmers hung reflective ribbons above the pond to deter herons from (　　) on young koi carp.

1 praying　**2** preying　**3** pressing　**4** praising

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

---

(16) The apprenticeship program welcomes applicants from all walks of life, regardless of their prior academic (　　).

1 background　**2** backbone　**3** backyard　**4** backlash

(17) With three nurses out sick, the clinic had to (　　) routine checkups to focus on urgent fever patients.

1 derive　**2** deduce　**3** depict　**4** defer

2

長文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Why Airport Carpets Quietly Calm Travelers

Major rail terminals tend to favor polished stone floors that withstand millions of rolling suitcases, yet many international airports still cover long departure piers with miles of patterned carpet. Cleaning carpet takes extra effort, so travelers sometimes wonder why operators keep installing soft flooring beyond security checkpoints.

Acoustics and pacing explain the choice. Hard stone corridors bounce announcements, footsteps, and wheel clatter back and forth, raising stress among passengers already worried about boarding times. Carpet absorbs high-frequency noise so gate calls remain intelligible at lower volume. Softer underfoot resistance also slows walking speed slightly without people realizing it. (18), crowds move more smoothly and waiting areas feel calmer.

Maintenance teams manage wear by laying modular carpet squares rather than single giant rolls. When coffee spills near a café or wheel tracks wear down a central lane, crews swap out only the damaged fifty-centimeter tiles overnight. (19), subtle wave patterns inspired by local coastlines hide minor scuffs between deep cleanings.

Airport flooring shows how material choices quietly shape behavior, proving that (20).

(18)

1 On the contrary
2 As a result
3 Otherwise
4 Despite this

(19)

1 Instead
2 Previously
3 Moreover
4 Regardless

(20)

1 comfort and practical upkeep can work together in busy public spaces
2 airports should ban wheeled suitcases from departure gates
3 stone floors absorb more sound than thick wool tiles
4 announcements are clearest when played at maximum volume

When Seaweed Farms Help Shellfish Neighbours

Along rocky coasts from Hokkaido to Maine, shellfish growers raising oysters and scallops face a quiet chemical challenge. As oceans absorb excess carbon dioxide from the atmosphere, coastal waters become slightly more acidic, making it harder for young shellfish larvae to build sturdy calcium shells during their first weeks of life.

Marine researchers testing ways to buffer local waters noticed a promising partner already familiar to coastal cuisine: fast-growing kelp and other seaweeds. Like land plants, kelp draws dissolved carbon dioxide out of seawater during daylight hours as it photosynthesizes. Hanging curtains of kelp on ropes just upstream of oyster cages measurably raises water pH in the surrounding bay while releasing oxygen. (21), juvenile oysters raised beside seaweed lines develop thicker shells than those grown in open water nearby.

Sharing ocean leases benefits farmers economically as well. Kelp grows fastest in cold winter and early spring months when shellfish work is relatively quiet, allowing crews to use the same boats, buoys, and anchor lines across seasons. Harvested seaweed can be sold for food, fertilizer, or animal feed supplements. (22), kelp blades absorb excess nitrogen washing off farmland, reducing summer algae blooms that otherwise suffocate coastal beds.

Co-cultivating seaweed and shellfish will not reverse global ocean chemistry on its own. Even so, pairing complementary marine crops gives coastal communities (23).

(21)

1 Nevertheless
2 On the other hand
3 Until then
4 Consequently

(22)

1 In addition
2 Instead
3 Otherwise
4 By contrast

(23)

1 a reason to abandon oyster farming in cold climates
2 a practical local defense that strengthens both harvests and water quality
3 a method for growing tropical fruit underwater
4 complete immunity from winter ocean storms

3 長文の内容一致選択
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Updated Procedures for Ceramic Kiln Firing

From: S. Takemoto, Community Craft Center
To: Advanced Pottery Members
Subject: Moisture checks and shelf tags before Friday's glaze firing

Dear pottery members,
Our monthly high-temperature glaze firing is scheduled for this Friday evening. During last month's run, one thick-walled flower vase cracked violently because moisture was still trapped deep inside the clay, scattering fragments onto neighboring bowls on the middle shelf. To protect everyone's work, we are introducing two mandatory steps starting this week.

First, all bisque-fired pieces glazed on Wednesday or Thursday must sit on the heated drying rack in Studio B for at least twenty-four hours before entering the kiln. Pieces glazed on Friday afternoon will be held over for next month's firing, with no exceptions.

Second, if you apply a runny ash glaze that tends to flow near 1,250 degrees Celsius, you must place your piece on a personal ceramic "cookie" slab and attach a yellow shelf tag. Staff load tagged items on the bottom shelf so any melted glaze drips onto your own slab rather than fusing permanently to the center's expensive silicon-carbide kiln shelves.

Unloading will begin Monday at 2:00 p.m., once the chamber has cooled below 60 degrees.

Best regards,
S. Takemoto

Updated Procedures for Ceramic Kiln Firing — Questions

(24) What problem occurred during last month's glaze firing?

1 The kiln failed to reach 60 degrees Celsius.

2 All yellow shelf tags burned before the kiln was closed.

3 A thick vase with trapped moisture cracked and damaged nearby bowls.

4 Members unloaded their bowls while the shelves were still glowing hot.

(25) What will happen to a piece that a member glazes on Friday afternoon?

1 It will be dried with a hair dryer and fired Friday night.

2 It will be kept for next month's firing rather than loaded this Friday.

3 It will be placed on the top shelf for extra heat.

4 It will be fired without any glaze.

(26) Why must pieces with runny ash glazes sit on a personal ceramic slab and carry a yellow tag?

1 Because silicon-carbide shelves cannot hold bowls heavier than a vase.

2 Because ash glazes turn bright yellow below 60 degrees.

3 So visitors can buy those pieces directly from Studio B.

4 So melted glaze drips onto the owner's slab instead of ruining the center's kiln shelves.

Why Packaging Engineers Study Origami Creases

Cardboard shipping boxes and beverage cartons look simple until you try designing one that folds flat in a warehouse, pops into shape on a high-speed filling line, resists crushing when stacked two meters high, and opens cleanly without scissors. Over the past fifteen years, packaging engineers seeking lighter, recyclable containers have found unexpected inspiration in the geometry of traditional Japanese origami.

In structural engineering, a flat sheet of thin paper bends effortlessly, yet adding a pattern of angled creases gives that same sheet remarkable stiffness. Aerospace researchers famously used "Miura-ori" folds to pack solar panels tightly inside rockets and unfold them in a single smooth pull in orbit. Packaging laboratories realized that similar crease networks could let thinner paperboard support heavy groceries or fragile electronics without relying on molded plastic foam inserts.

Origami geometry also cuts waste on factory floors. Conventional cushioned boxes often glue together three or four separate layers of cardboard and plastic film, making recycling awkward for households. A single die-cut sheet scored with precise valley and mountain folds, by contrast, can fold inward to form its own springy corner bumpers. Because no glue joins dissimilar materials, the entire package goes straight into standard paper recycling bins once unpacked.

Translating hand-folded art into industrial machinery has not been effortless. Paper fibers crack if bent too sharply at three hundred cartons per minute, and humid summer warehouses soften creases differently than dry winter air. Engineers therefore test fiber grain direction and press rounded micro-scores rather than sharp knife lines so folds flex reliably across seasons.

What began as centuries-old paper craft now helps manufacturers ship everyday goods with less bulk, less plastic, and smarter structural strength.

Why Packaging Engineers Study Origami Creases — Questions

(27) How did origami crease geometry help packaging laboratories reduce plastic use?

1 Angled fold patterns give thin paperboard enough stiffness and cushioning to replace plastic foam inserts.

2 Origami paper melts into a waterproof plastic coating when heated.

3 Rockets deliver cardboard boxes directly to supermarkets.

4 Thin paper sheets become heavier than steel when left flat.

(28) Why is a single folded paperboard insert easier for households to recycle than conventional cushioned boxes?

1 Households must mail conventional boxes back to aerospace labs.

2 Standard recycling bins accept only plastic foam.

3 It forms springy corner bumpers from one material without gluing paper to plastic film.

4 Single-sheet boxes dissolve completely in kitchen sinks.

(29) What manufacturing challenge did engineers face when adapting intricate folds to high-speed machines?

1 Factory machines could fold only three cartons per day.

2 Beverage cartons were too large to fit inside warehouses.

3 Origami artists refused to share ruler measurements.

4 Paper fibers could crack at high speeds and seasonal humidity altered how creases behaved.

(30) How did engineers prevent paper fibers from cracking on fast production lines?

1 By soaking every carton in oil before folding.

2 By folding every shipping box by hand at home.

3 By testing fiber grain direction and pressing rounded micro-scores instead of sharp lines.

4 By replacing paperboard with thick aluminum plates.

Why Packaging Engineers Study Origami Creases — Questions (continued)

(31) Which statement best summarizes the passage?

1 Plastic foam remains the only safe material for shipping fragile electronics.

2 Traditional folding principles, refined through modern engineering, enable stronger and less wasteful packaging.

3 Origami techniques work well in space exploration but fail in everyday commerce.

4 Consumers prefer packages that require scissors and strong glue to open.